

Share Your Knowledge

If you are an expert in your field of electronics, why not share your knowledge with the world?



Electronics For You invites electronics professionals and industry experts to write articles on their area of expertise and interest from different perspectives

Some of the topics we want you to write about are:

- Photonics: Optics & Optoelectronics
- Automation
- Power Electronics
- Components
- Telecom

So if you have an interesting topic or original article to share, please let us know at efyeditorial@efy.in

We would love to hear your good ideas too!

electronics
FOR YOU

MAJOR CONTRIBUTORS TO THIS REPORT



Abdul Basith,
executive director,
Euro Lights, India



G. Jeganathan,
director, GTP
Equipments
India Pvt Ltd



I. Hari Prasad,
Omtronics



Joy Biswas,
product manager,
Forbix Semicon



Siva Satheesh,
managing director,
Euro Lights, India



T.A. Babu,
managing director,
Quantum Dots
Technology Pvt Ltd

pendent of these servers. They are now working on a better system that works on webmail servers, where triggers are sent through webmail, thus allowing for redundancy in the case of disrupted communication.

Plugging in some smarts

Not in the mood to build your own smart lighting system? There are some amazing products available that can let you plug in a smart lighting system into your home without having to get your hands dirty with code.

Philips Hue has stepped things up a notch. You can now use your iOS phone to not just switch on and off bulbs, but also pick colour, brightness and program timing, too. It also lets you use If This Then That service to get your lighting system to respond to situations like flashing red for a call from, say, your in-laws.

Elgato's Avea is another Bluetooth Smart bulb rated at 7W and 430lm. Belkin has a similar functioning solution in its WeMo branded LED bulbs. LIFX is a similar product but works on Wi-Fi instead of Bluetooth Low Energy. Belkin has also brought out a WeMo light switch that lets you control dumb bulbs with your phone.

If you really want to take things ahead with your existing lighting and home electronics, then LightwaveRF has a solution to swap your home's sockets with their Internet-enabled switches. GE Link is another option that lets you remotely control and sync to a connected device through an app called Wink.

Those on a budget can look at Cree Connected LEDs, as these are

one of the most inexpensive bets available. For a more all-inclusive integration, Lutron has a product named HomeWorks QS that can control not just light but interior and exterior systems, audio-visual and heating, ventilation and air-conditioning, making it more of a home environment control system. In line with this concept, it also lets you create scenes, which are preset light and shade levels. For example, press Entertain button on the keypad in your living room, and lights and shades will adjust throughout your home to create the pre-planned ambience.

What will happen to the switch

The US Navy's design principle, "Keep it simple, stupid," is now repeated by many designers. What can be simpler than a light switch? No switch!

Smart lighting is built on the premise that not only can you control your lights from anywhere, you can also set these up such that these do the controlling on their own. That means no more fumbling for the light switch when you get back home at night, or when you make your way to the kitchen in the middle of the night.

"There is a possibility that a new product that is highly innovative might not necessarily be cost-effective, user-friendly or eco-friendly. But when a new product or component meets these three criteria and satisfies customer requirements successfully with high satisfaction, then change is inevitable," explains G. Jeganathan, director, GTP Equipments India Pvt Ltd. ●